

A firm believer in astrology, numerology and superstitions, he continues to reside in his relatively small ministerial bungalow, opposite the Race Course, giving away the official chief minister's bungalow, Anugraha, to his colleague, Home Minister V.S. Acharya. Anugraha had been home to most chief ministers, the last being Kumaraswamy. Yeddyurappa's belief that staying at the residence would jinx his career is keeping him away from Anugraha. Such are his superstitions that he replaced an I with a Y in his name a week after the JD(S) failed to transfer power as per the agreement in October 2007.

lected region. He told INDIA TODAY that the "first thing my Government will do is to amend Article 371 of the Constitution and bring in a special reservation policy for getting rightful share in educational and employment opportunities". Trying to implement all recommendations of the High Power Committee for Redressal of Regional Imbalances, formerly headed by the late D.M. Nanjundappa, is a Herculean task.

While the private sector bluechip titans like Infosys showcase their buildings and prowess within their campuses with pride to the world, an internationally known mega city like

Bangalore is but evidence of a lack of political will exhibited by the state Government.

If this wasn't enough, Yeddyurappa's Operation Lotus, which he believes is a political polarisation to get Congress and JD(S) legislators into the BJP, was not sustainable as a long-term plan. Congress leader V. Somanna who crossed over to the BJP and was made a temple minister lost to a 26-year-old greenhorn from the Congress, Priyakrishna, in the August 2009 by-elections. Independents who propped up the Yeddyurappa Government in May 2008 are scared of losing their jobs



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Strengths

Energetic, disciplined, spots talent, relies on key officials, does not have a strong Opposition, Congress is in doldrums, only JD(S) is effective, prefers to play regional satrap only.

Opportunities

Big backing from Lingayat community could help consolidate his position at the top, can tap into RSS resources, has the potential to bulldoze his vision for the state through.

Weaknesses

Lacks cohesive team of ministers, short temper, no clear strategy to counter Opposition, inability to crack the whip on inefficient babudom/government servants.

Threats

There is a perception that he has a Hindutva agenda, his detractors are on the rise nationally, is being blinded of ground realities by his coterie.

Lately, his penchant for foreign travel has raised quite a few eyebrows. Earlier this year, he spent a few days in China ostensibly to attract investment for a global investors' meet in Bangalore in January 2010. He will be travelling again with his team to the US, Japan and Sweden in the next few weeks. This is not viewed kindly by some people, primarily because some of the promises he made are yet to be kept. In May 2008, Yeddyurappa was vocal about his take on the Hyderabad-Karnataka neg-

Bangalore groans under the weight of garbage strewn on the roads, millions of vehicles clogging its roads, traffic police overburdened with poisonous fumes, frequent power failures and the drinking water situation at an all-time low. Some residential areas in the city—a majority of which the BJP represents—don't see water for days. Taps just run dry. Obviously there is something rotten somewhere. It is not that the political leadership have not known the ills plaguing the city. The present condition of

now that the BJP has ramped up its House strength on its own with impressive wins in two by-elections (115 MLAs on its own apart from the Speaker and a nominated member). Yeddyurappa also helped contribute 19 seats to the national party kitty in the April 2009 Lok Sabha polls, the highest for any state or Union territory.

The Karnataka chief minister is also revamping the party apparatus. State party chief D.V. Sadananda Gowda will make way for a new man.